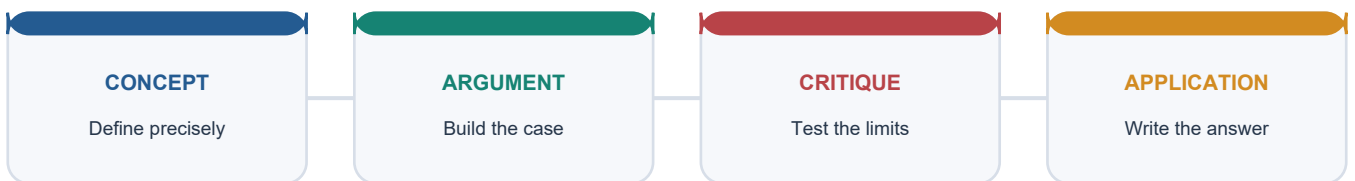


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Interpersonal-and-Communication-Skills - CSAT Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Diagnostic set - Questions 1-16

Q1. A notice uses technical abbreviations that residents do not understand.

What is the primary communication problem?

A. Semantic barrier B. Lack of any objective C. Mathematical error D. No stakeholder exists

Q2. A notice uses technical abbreviations that residents do not understand.

What is the best first response?

A. Ignore the concern B. Rewrite in plain language and test comprehension C. Escalate hostility D. Make an unsupported promise

Q3. A notice uses technical abbreviations that residents do not understand.

Which channel is most suitable?

A. A vague informal rumour B. No communication C. Written notice plus a help channel D. An unrelated mass advertisement

Q4. A notice uses technical abbreviations that residents do not understand.

Which principle is central?

A. Aggression B. Secrecy without reason C. Assuming motives D. Clarity and feedback

Q5. Two departments issue conflicting instructions to the same field team.

What is the primary communication problem?

A. Organisational barrier B. Lack of any objective C. Mathematical error D. No stakeholder exists

Q6. Two departments issue conflicting instructions to the same field team.

What is the best first response?

A. Ignore the concern B. Clarify authority and issue one reconciled instruction C. Escalate hostility D. Make an unsupported promise

Q7. Two departments issue conflicting instructions to the same field team.

Which channel is most suitable?

A. A vague informal rumour B. No communication C. Documented joint briefing D. An unrelated mass advertisement

Q8. Two departments issue conflicting instructions to the same field team.

Which principle is central?

A. Aggression B. Secrecy without reason C. Assuming motives D. Consistency and accountability

Q9. A citizen is angry after repeated visits for the same certificate.

What is the primary communication problem?

- A. Psychological barrier B. Lack of any objective C. Mathematical error D. No stakeholder exists

Q10. A citizen is angry after repeated visits for the same certificate.

What is the best first response?

- A. Ignore the concern B. Listen, acknowledge, explain the next lawful step and record follow-up C. Escalate hostility D. Make an unsupported promise

Q11. A citizen is angry after repeated visits for the same certificate.

Which channel is most suitable?

- A. A vague informal rumour B. No communication C. Private face-to-face or assisted channel D. An unrelated mass advertisement

Q12. A citizen is angry after repeated visits for the same certificate.

Which principle is central?

- A. Aggression B. Secrecy without reason C. Assuming motives D. Empathy with procedural fairness

Q13. A public meeting is dominated by a few loud participants.

What is the primary communication problem?

- A. Participation barrier B. Lack of any objective C. Mathematical error D. No stakeholder exists

Q14. A public meeting is dominated by a few loud participants.

What is the best first response?

- A. Ignore the concern B. Use moderated turns and invite quieter groups C. Escalate hostility D. Make an unsupported promise

Q15. A public meeting is dominated by a few loud participants.

Which channel is most suitable?

- A. A vague informal rumour B. No communication C. Facilitated small-group consultation D. An unrelated mass advertisement

Q16. A public meeting is dominated by a few loud participants.

Which principle is central?

- A. Aggression B. Secrecy without reason C. Assuming motives D. Inclusion

Graded set - Questions 17-32

Q17. An officer gives feedback by attacking an employee's personality.

What is the primary communication problem?

- A. Interpersonal barrier B. Lack of any objective C. Mathematical error D. No stakeholder exists

Q18. An officer gives feedback by attacking an employee's personality.

What is the best first response?

A. Ignore the concern B. Describe the specific behaviour, impact and expected change C. Escalate hostility D. Make an unsupported promise

Q19. An officer gives feedback by attacking an employee's personality.

Which channel is most suitable?

A. A vague informal rumour B. No communication C. Private two-way conversation D. An unrelated mass advertisement

Q20. An officer gives feedback by attacking an employee's personality.

Which principle is central?

A. Aggression B. Secrecy without reason C. Assuming motives D. Behaviour-focused feedback

Q21. A survey asks, 'Do you agree that the excellent new service should continue?'

What is the primary communication problem?

A. Leading-question bias B. Lack of any objective C. Mathematical error D. No stakeholder exists

Q22. A survey asks, 'Do you agree that the excellent new service should continue?'

What is the best first response?

A. Ignore the concern B. Use neutral wording C. Escalate hostility D. Make an unsupported promise

Q23. A survey asks, 'Do you agree that the excellent new service should continue?'

Which channel is most suitable?

A. A vague informal rumour B. No communication C. Anonymous questionnaire with pilot testing D. An unrelated mass advertisement

Q24. A survey asks, 'Do you agree that the excellent new service should continue?'

Which principle is central?

A. Aggression B. Secrecy without reason C. Assuming motives D. Neutral measurement

Q25. A form asks, 'Was the office clean and the staff helpful?'

What is the primary communication problem?

A. Double-barrelled question B. Lack of any objective C. Mathematical error D. No stakeholder exists

Q26. A form asks, 'Was the office clean and the staff helpful?'

What is the best first response?

A. Ignore the concern B. Split cleanliness and helpfulness into separate items C. Escalate hostility D. Make an unsupported promise

Q27. A form asks, 'Was the office clean and the staff helpful?'

Which channel is most suitable?

A. A vague informal rumour B. No communication C. Structured questionnaire D. An unrelated mass advertisement

Q28. A form asks, 'Was the office clean and the staff helpful?'

Which principle is central?

A. Aggression B. Secrecy without reason C. Assuming motives D. One issue per question

Q29. A rumour spreads during a local emergency.

What is the primary communication problem?

A. Misinformation barrier B. Lack of any objective C. Mathematical error D. No stakeholder exists

Q30. A rumour spreads during a local emergency.

What is the best first response?

A. Ignore the concern B. Issue rapid verified updates and correct false claims transparently C. Escalate hostility D. Make an unsupported promise

Q31. A rumour spreads during a local emergency.

Which channel is most suitable?

A. A vague informal rumour B. No communication C. Repeated multi-channel bulletin D. An unrelated mass advertisement

Q32. A rumour spreads during a local emergency.

Which principle is central?

A. Aggression B. Secrecy without reason C. Assuming motives D. Speed with accuracy

Remedial and timed set - Questions 33-48

Q33. Two groups dispute access to a shared facility.

What is the primary communication problem?

A. Conflict of interests B. Lack of any objective C. Mathematical error D. No stakeholder exists

Q34. Two groups dispute access to a shared facility.

What is the best first response?

A. Ignore the concern B. Identify interests, objective criteria and feasible trade-offs C. Escalate hostility D. Make an unsupported promise

Q35. Two groups dispute access to a shared facility.

Which channel is most suitable?

A. A vague informal rumour B. No communication C. Mediated negotiation D. An unrelated mass advertisement

Q36. Two groups dispute access to a shared facility.

Which principle is central?

A. Aggression B. Secrecy without reason C. Assuming motives D. Problem-solving

Q37. A supervisor says yes to every demand but later cannot deliver.

What is the primary communication problem?

- A. Passive communication B. Lack of any objective C. Mathematical error D. No stakeholder exists

Q38. A supervisor says yes to every demand but later cannot deliver.

What is the best first response?

- A. Ignore the concern B. State constraints respectfully and commit only to feasible action C. Escalate hostility D. Make an unsupported promise

Q39. A supervisor says yes to every demand but later cannot deliver.

Which channel is most suitable?

- A. A vague informal rumour B. No communication C. Assertive discussion D. An unrelated mass advertisement

Q40. A supervisor says yes to every demand but later cannot deliver.

Which principle is central?

- A. Aggression B. Secrecy without reason C. Assuming motives D. Honesty and boundaries

Q41. A message is accurate but reaches workers after the deadline.

What is the primary communication problem?

- A. Physical/timing barrier B. Lack of any objective C. Mathematical error D. No stakeholder exists

Q42. A message is accurate but reaches workers after the deadline.

What is the best first response?

- A. Ignore the concern B. Use a faster channel and confirm receipt C. Escalate hostility D. Make an unsupported promise

Q43. A message is accurate but reaches workers after the deadline.

Which channel is most suitable?

- A. A vague informal rumour B. No communication C. Urgent direct alert plus record D. An unrelated mass advertisement

Q44. A message is accurate but reaches workers after the deadline.

Which principle is central?

- A. Aggression B. Secrecy without reason C. Assuming motives D. Timeliness

Q45. A multilingual audience receives a message in only one unfamiliar language.

What is the primary communication problem?

- A. Language barrier B. Lack of any objective C. Mathematical error D. No stakeholder exists

Q46. A multilingual audience receives a message in only one unfamiliar language.

What is the best first response?

- A. Ignore the concern B. Translate and use accessible examples C. Escalate hostility D. Make an unsupported promise

Q47. A multilingual audience receives a message in only one unfamiliar language.

Which channel is most suitable?

A. A vague informal rumour B. No communication C. Local-language audio and text D. An unrelated mass advertisement

Q48. A multilingual audience receives a message in only one unfamiliar language.

Which principle is central?

A. Aggression B. Secrecy without reason C. Assuming motives D. Accessibility

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Complete step-by-step solutions

Q1. A notice uses technical abbreviations that residents do not understand.

What is the primary communication problem?

A. Semantic barrier B. Lack of any objective C. Mathematical error D. No stakeholder exists

Correct answer: A. Diagnose the barrier shown by the facts.

Q2. A notice uses technical abbreviations that residents do not understand.

What is the best first response?

A. Ignore the concern B. Rewrite in plain language and test comprehension C. Escalate hostility D. Make an unsupported promise

Correct answer: B. The response addresses the diagnosed barrier while preserving feasibility and respect.

Q3. A notice uses technical abbreviations that residents do not understand.

Which channel is most suitable?

A. A vague informal rumour B. No communication C. Written notice plus a help channel D. An unrelated mass advertisement

Correct answer: C. Channel choice follows urgency, complexity, inclusion, privacy and record needs.

Q4. A notice uses technical abbreviations that residents do not understand.

Which principle is central?

A. Aggression B. Secrecy without reason C. Assuming motives D. Clarity and feedback

Correct answer: D. The principle follows directly from the scenario and remedy.

Q5. Two departments issue conflicting instructions to the same field team.

What is the primary communication problem?

A. Organisational barrier B. Lack of any objective C. Mathematical error D. No stakeholder exists

Correct answer: A. Diagnose the barrier shown by the facts.

Q6. Two departments issue conflicting instructions to the same field team.

What is the best first response?

A. Ignore the concern B. Clarify authority and issue one reconciled instruction C. Escalate hostility D. Make an unsupported promise

Correct answer: B. The response addresses the diagnosed barrier while preserving feasibility and respect.

Q7. Two departments issue conflicting instructions to the same field team.

Which channel is most suitable?

A. A vague informal rumour B. No communication C. Documented joint briefing D. An unrelated mass advertisement

Correct answer: C. Channel choice follows urgency, complexity, inclusion, privacy and record needs.

Q8. Two departments issue conflicting instructions to the same field team.

Which principle is central?

A. Aggression B. Secrecy without reason C. Assuming motives D. Consistency and accountability

Correct answer: D. The principle follows directly from the scenario and remedy.

Q9. A citizen is angry after repeated visits for the same certificate.

What is the primary communication problem?

A. Psychological barrier B. Lack of any objective C. Mathematical error D. No stakeholder exists

Correct answer: A. Diagnose the barrier shown by the facts.

Q10. A citizen is angry after repeated visits for the same certificate.

What is the best first response?

A. Ignore the concern B. Listen, acknowledge, explain the next lawful step and record follow-up C. Escalate hostility D. Make an unsupported promise

Correct answer: B. The response addresses the diagnosed barrier while preserving feasibility and respect.

Q11. A citizen is angry after repeated visits for the same certificate.

Which channel is most suitable?

A. A vague informal rumour B. No communication C. Private face-to-face or assisted channel D. An unrelated mass advertisement

Correct answer: C. Channel choice follows urgency, complexity, inclusion, privacy and record needs.

Q12. A citizen is angry after repeated visits for the same certificate.

Which principle is central?

A. Aggression B. Secrecy without reason C. Assuming motives D. Empathy with procedural fairness

Correct answer: D. The principle follows directly from the scenario and remedy.

Q13. A public meeting is dominated by a few loud participants.

What is the primary communication problem?

A. Participation barrier B. Lack of any objective C. Mathematical error D. No stakeholder exists

Correct answer: A. Diagnose the barrier shown by the facts.

Q14. A public meeting is dominated by a few loud participants.

What is the best first response?

A. Ignore the concern B. Use moderated turns and invite quieter groups C. Escalate hostility D. Make an unsupported promise

Correct answer: B. The response addresses the diagnosed barrier while preserving feasibility and respect.

Q15. A public meeting is dominated by a few loud participants.

Which channel is most suitable?

A. A vague informal rumour B. No communication C. Facilitated small-group consultation D. An unrelated mass advertisement

Correct answer: C. Channel choice follows urgency, complexity, inclusion, privacy and record needs.

Q16. A public meeting is dominated by a few loud participants.

Which principle is central?

A. Aggression B. Secrecy without reason C. Assuming motives D. Inclusion

Correct answer: D. The principle follows directly from the scenario and remedy.

Q17. An officer gives feedback by attacking an employee's personality.

What is the primary communication problem?

A. Interpersonal barrier B. Lack of any objective C. Mathematical error D. No stakeholder exists

Correct answer: A. Diagnose the barrier shown by the facts.

Q18. An officer gives feedback by attacking an employee's personality.

What is the best first response?

A. Ignore the concern B. Describe the specific behaviour, impact and expected change C. Escalate hostility D. Make an unsupported promise

Correct answer: B. The response addresses the diagnosed barrier while preserving feasibility and respect.

Q19. An officer gives feedback by attacking an employee's personality.

Which channel is most suitable?

A. A vague informal rumour B. No communication C. Private two-way conversation D. An unrelated mass advertisement

Correct answer: C. Channel choice follows urgency, complexity, inclusion, privacy and record needs.

Q20. An officer gives feedback by attacking an employee's personality.

Which principle is central?

A. Aggression B. Secrecy without reason C. Assuming motives D. Behaviour-focused feedback

Correct answer: D. The principle follows directly from the scenario and remedy.

Q21. A survey asks, 'Do you agree that the excellent new service should continue?'

What is the primary communication problem?

- A. Leading-question bias B. Lack of any objective C. Mathematical error D. No stakeholder exists

Correct answer: A. Diagnose the barrier shown by the facts.

Q22. A survey asks, 'Do you agree that the excellent new service should continue?'

What is the best first response?

- A. Ignore the concern B. Use neutral wording C. Escalate hostility D. Make an unsupported promise

Correct answer: B. The response addresses the diagnosed barrier while preserving feasibility and respect.

Q23. A survey asks, 'Do you agree that the excellent new service should continue?'

Which channel is most suitable?

- A. A vague informal rumour B. No communication C. Anonymous questionnaire with pilot testing D. An unrelated mass advertisement

Correct answer: C. Channel choice follows urgency, complexity, inclusion, privacy and record needs.

Q24. A survey asks, 'Do you agree that the excellent new service should continue?'

Which principle is central?

- A. Aggression B. Secrecy without reason C. Assuming motives D. Neutral measurement

Correct answer: D. The principle follows directly from the scenario and remedy.

Q25. A form asks, 'Was the office clean and the staff helpful?'

What is the primary communication problem?

- A. Double-barrelled question B. Lack of any objective C. Mathematical error D. No stakeholder exists

Correct answer: A. Diagnose the barrier shown by the facts.

Q26. A form asks, 'Was the office clean and the staff helpful?'

What is the best first response?

- A. Ignore the concern B. Split cleanliness and helpfulness into separate items C. Escalate hostility D. Make an unsupported promise

Correct answer: B. The response addresses the diagnosed barrier while preserving feasibility and respect.

Q27. A form asks, 'Was the office clean and the staff helpful?'

Which channel is most suitable?

- A. A vague informal rumour B. No communication C. Structured questionnaire D. An unrelated mass advertisement

Correct answer: C. Channel choice follows urgency, complexity, inclusion, privacy and record needs.

Q28. A form asks, 'Was the office clean and the staff helpful?'

Which principle is central?

- A. Aggression B. Secrecy without reason C. Assuming motives D. One issue per question

Correct answer: D. The principle follows directly from the scenario and remedy.

Q29. A rumour spreads during a local emergency.

What is the primary communication problem?

A. Misinformation barrier B. Lack of any objective C. Mathematical error D. No stakeholder exists

Correct answer: A. Diagnose the barrier shown by the facts.

Q30. A rumour spreads during a local emergency.

What is the best first response?

A. Ignore the concern B. Issue rapid verified updates and correct false claims transparently C. Escalate hostility D. Make an unsupported promise

Correct answer: B. The response addresses the diagnosed barrier while preserving feasibility and respect.

Q31. A rumour spreads during a local emergency.

Which channel is most suitable?

A. A vague informal rumour B. No communication C. Repeated multi-channel bulletin D. An unrelated mass advertisement

Correct answer: C. Channel choice follows urgency, complexity, inclusion, privacy and record needs.

Q32. A rumour spreads during a local emergency.

Which principle is central?

A. Aggression B. Secrecy without reason C. Assuming motives D. Speed with accuracy

Correct answer: D. The principle follows directly from the scenario and remedy.

Q33. Two groups dispute access to a shared facility.

What is the primary communication problem?

A. Conflict of interests B. Lack of any objective C. Mathematical error D. No stakeholder exists

Correct answer: A. Diagnose the barrier shown by the facts.

Q34. Two groups dispute access to a shared facility.

What is the best first response?

A. Ignore the concern B. Identify interests, objective criteria and feasible trade-offs C. Escalate hostility D. Make an unsupported promise

Correct answer: B. The response addresses the diagnosed barrier while preserving feasibility and respect.

Q35. Two groups dispute access to a shared facility.

Which channel is most suitable?

A. A vague informal rumour B. No communication C. Mediated negotiation D. An unrelated mass advertisement

Correct answer: C. Channel choice follows urgency, complexity, inclusion, privacy and record needs.

Q36. Two groups dispute access to a shared facility.

Which principle is central?

A. Aggression B. Secrecy without reason C. Assuming motives D. Problem-solving

Correct answer: D. The principle follows directly from the scenario and remedy.

Q37. A supervisor says yes to every demand but later cannot deliver.

What is the primary communication problem?

- A. Passive communication B. Lack of any objective C. Mathematical error D. No stakeholder exists

Correct answer: A. Diagnose the barrier shown by the facts.

Q38. A supervisor says yes to every demand but later cannot deliver.

What is the best first response?

- A. Ignore the concern B. State constraints respectfully and commit only to feasible action C. Escalate hostility D. Make an unsupported promise

Correct answer: B. The response addresses the diagnosed barrier while preserving feasibility and respect.

Q39. A supervisor says yes to every demand but later cannot deliver.

Which channel is most suitable?

- A. A vague informal rumour B. No communication C. Assertive discussion D. An unrelated mass advertisement

Correct answer: C. Channel choice follows urgency, complexity, inclusion, privacy and record needs.

Q40. A supervisor says yes to every demand but later cannot deliver.

Which principle is central?

- A. Aggression B. Secrecy without reason C. Assuming motives D. Honesty and boundaries

Correct answer: D. The principle follows directly from the scenario and remedy.

Q41. A message is accurate but reaches workers after the deadline.

What is the primary communication problem?

- A. Physical/timing barrier B. Lack of any objective C. Mathematical error D. No stakeholder exists

Correct answer: A. Diagnose the barrier shown by the facts.

Q42. A message is accurate but reaches workers after the deadline.

What is the best first response?

- A. Ignore the concern B. Use a faster channel and confirm receipt C. Escalate hostility D. Make an unsupported promise

Correct answer: B. The response addresses the diagnosed barrier while preserving feasibility and respect.

Q43. A message is accurate but reaches workers after the deadline.

Which channel is most suitable?

- A. A vague informal rumour B. No communication C. Urgent direct alert plus record D. An unrelated mass advertisement

Correct answer: C. Channel choice follows urgency, complexity, inclusion, privacy and record needs.

Q44. A message is accurate but reaches workers after the deadline.

Which principle is central?

- A. Aggression B. Secrecy without reason C. Assuming motives D. Timeliness

Correct answer: D. The principle follows directly from the scenario and remedy.

Q45. A multilingual audience receives a message in only one unfamiliar language.

What is the primary communication problem?

A. Language barrier B. Lack of any objective C. Mathematical error D. No stakeholder exists

Correct answer: A. Diagnose the barrier shown by the facts.

Q46. A multilingual audience receives a message in only one unfamiliar language.

What is the best first response?

A. Ignore the concern B. Translate and use accessible examples C. Escalate hostility D. Make an unsupported promise

Correct answer: B. The response addresses the diagnosed barrier while preserving feasibility and respect.

Q47. A multilingual audience receives a message in only one unfamiliar language.

Which channel is most suitable?

A. A vague informal rumour B. No communication C. Local-language audio and text D. An unrelated mass advertisement

Correct answer: C. Channel choice follows urgency, complexity, inclusion, privacy and record needs.

Q48. A multilingual audience receives a message in only one unfamiliar language.

Which principle is central?

A. Aggression B. Secrecy without reason C. Assuming motives D. Accessibility

Correct answer: D. The principle follows directly from the scenario and remedy.

Verified PYQ routing ledger

Year	Q	Neutral verified demand	Locally checked Set-A key/status	Solution architecture
2026	72	Communication: relationship matching	B (provisional)	Draw a labelled generation graph.
2026	73	Communication: tool-purpose matching	C (provisional)	Diagnose the barrier or purpose, then choose the feasible inclusive response.
2026	74	Communication: conflict scenario	C (provisional)	Diagnose the barrier or purpose, then choose the feasible inclusive response.
2026	75	Communication: barrier-example matching	D (provisional)	Diagnose the barrier or purpose, then choose the feasible inclusive response.
2026	76	Communication: questionnaire scenario	C (provisional)	Diagnose the barrier or purpose, then choose the feasible inclusive response.
2026	77	Communication: statements	D (provisional)	Diagnose the barrier or purpose, then choose the feasible inclusive response.

Final error-log checklist

- Was the family classified correctly?
- Were units, domains, quantifiers and constraints copied correctly?
- Was the first-principles relation written before a shortcut?
- Was the selected option independently recomputed or supported by the passage?
- Was the mistake logged and followed by a fresh remedial item?